

# Tingrui Zhang

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## Skills and Interests

- Research Interests: Development Economics, Labor Economics, and Behavior Economics.  
Technical Proficiencies: Data Analysis (Stata, MATLAB, Excel); Coding (Python); Database Management (SQL); Cloud Computing (Amazon AWS).  
Link to AWS Cloud Computing Project: <https://github.com/mac30123-s26/Greenness-Happiness-and-Willingness.git>
- Graphical Designing: Video Editing (Wondershare); Picture Processing (Canva, Snapseed); Media Operating.
- Language Skills: Chinese (Native), Academic & Business English writing & presentation

## Education

### The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

Shenzhen, China

*Bachelor of Business Administration in Applied Economics*

Sept 2021 – July 2025

- GPA: 3.852/4.000

Took foundation courses in economic theory, statistics and probabilities, math, and general education.

### University of Oxford

Oxford, UK

*Visiting student in Economics at Pembroke College*

Oct 2024 – June 2025

### University of Chicago

Chicago, US

*Master of Arts in Computational Social Science – Economics*

Aug 2025 – June 2027

- Took classes including Econometrics, Math, Computational Social Science Methods, Python Programming, and various economics classes involving inequality and education.

## Research Experience

### Learning About the Learning of Young Children Using High Frequency Data

*Research Assistant*

Dec 2025 – Apr 2026

- Conducted visualization, organization, and cleaning of data to present paper results, and proofreading of multiple versions
- Helped constructing an item response theory (IRT) model depicting skill formation process of children
- Completed translation and organization of raw curriculum files and difficulty level matching

### Soundtracks of a Crisis: Cross-Regional Divergence in Musical Coping Mechanisms During COVID-19

*Project Collaborator*

Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Together with two independent researchers, explored how public music consumption shifted during the COVID-19 pandemic, acting as an early predictor of societal stress or public attention
- Using Python, conducted web scraping, data cleaning, regression analysis, and predictive analysis
- Link to project repository: <https://github.com/tingruiray/Music-Trend-Analysis.git>

### Selection, Structural Transformation, and the Cost Disease of Services

*Research Assistant*

Mar 2024 – Oct 2024

- Modified a Structural Roy Model to prove that selection causes professional services to grow 14% faster in productivity than other services
- Conducted data cleaning on over 1.5 million observations, computed and graphed earning premium model estimation
- Discovered gender composition to be a vital factor in earning differential apart from worker self-selection, adding value for potential policy implications of the project
- Paper published in *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*

### Political Strategy and Corporate Social Responsibility

*Research Assistant*

July 2024 – Aug 2024

- Participated in a joint project by CUHKSZ and Zhongshan University by processing large company-based datasets
- Conducted data cleaning and gross matching for over 200,000 observations using Stata and Python

### The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

*Undergraduate Student Teaching Fellow for Introductory Macroeconomics*

Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Designed and gave lectures, tutorials, and gradings
- Accumulated over 40 working hours in total giving weekly tutorials and midterm review lectures

### Chronic Study of China's Gender Wage Differential

*Independent Researcher*

Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Designed a Generalized Linear Model to estimate the magnitude of China's gender wage gap, and applied Oaxaca Decomposition to analyze the factors contributing to the gap

- Yielded consistent conclusions indicating discrimination accounts for 73% of gender wage differential in 2017 & 81% in 2021

## **Work Experience**

### **Center for the Economics of Human Development**

Chicago, IL

*Research Assistant*

Dec 2025 – Present

- Assisted in multiple academic projects in the center involving data processing, paper translation, and model construction.

### **Shanghai Pudong Development Bank**

Nanjing, China

*Investment Bank Intern*

July 2024 – Aug 2024

- Conducted individual industry research in 5 projects by collecting data from various academic and industrial resources, involving Car Manufacturing, Shipping, Chemistry, and Real Estate
- Assisted in the feasibility report of underwriting 500 Million CNY Short-term Commercial Paper issued by Nanjing Railway Construction Investment Co., LTD

### **KPMG Huazhen LLP Nanjing Branch**

Nanjing, China

*Audit Intern (Cooperative)*

July 2023

- Completed sampling of over 500 transactions using Excel in Wuhu Urban Construction Group IPO Audit Project, accounting for one-third of the document inspection procedure
- Organized and double-checked over 800 pages of final reports in the EDF (Beijing) Audit Project

## **On-campus Activities and Social Practice**

### **Darlingo Club**

*Head of the Secretary Department*

Sept 2022 – June 2024

- Led a 10-people department to build a bridge of communication between the club, university, and students, which was vital for the club's focus on organizing traveling events
- Raised over CNY 4000 budget and delivered club news feeds to over 5000 students, increasing club members from around 100 to 196 in 2024 and making Darlingo one of the biggest clubs in the university

### **SME Academic Advisory Programme for Year 1 Students**

*Mentor*

Sept 2023 – Jan 2024

- Served in the mentor group for over 50 freshmen to help them better adapt to their university lives
- Held three Academic Advisor meetings sharing experiences on exchange application, academic writing, and course selection

### **‘Hand in Hand’ Voluntary Teaching Programme**

*Voluntary Physics Teacher & Team Leader*

May 2023 – June 2023

- Led a team of 11 voluntary teachers for a 2-week teaching programme at rural primary school
- Served as a physics teacher for over 30 students from grades 1, 2, and 3 and introduced them to basic physical principles like gravity, surface tension, and mediums of sound by conducting lab experiments

### **Cooking Pioneers**

*Financial Accountant*

Sept 2022 – June 2023

- Managed the club's budget and logistical operatives
- Accomplished planning, purchase and reimbursement of over 200 transactions totaling CNY 8,400

### **Campus Media Agents**

*Art & Video Editor*

Sept 2022 – June 2023

- Designed 2 posters using Canva for advertising at Annual Club Meeting
- As a team, edited videos using Wondershare for club activities and advertisements

## **Awards and Honors**

- *The Best Essay in General Education for AY 2023-2024*, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, School of Humanities and Social Science
- *Merit Award (Top 30)*, HKICPA Business Case Competition, 2023
- The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen *Academic Performance Scholarship* (2021-2023)
- The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen *Dean's List* (2021-2024)